

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto and previously with Metrolinx. Reviews technical submissions and data critically, turns multi-source data into validated reporting and KPIs, and writes the analysis that management decides from.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Review development applications, engineering submissions and consultant studies against City standards, test whether their assumptions hold, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, reconciling several years of data from separate sources into one validated source, so the division reports continuously rather than rebuilding a report each quarter.
- Analyze data for inconsistencies, trends and gaps, and turn the findings into briefing notes and presentations for management.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a resolution.
- Run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule and quality myself.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Established what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward, using OpenTrack simulation of GO rail services.
- Worked through large operations datasets across subdivisions and set out where the evidence pointed for schedulers, operations staff and engineers.
- Found ways to get scenario analysis through faster and more consistently as the volume of requests grew: a command line workflow pre-simulated temporary and permanent slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround from days to hours.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Data validation, reconciliation and performance reporting. KPIs and dashboards. Critical review of technical submissions. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL and advanced Excel. Briefing notes, memos and presentations. OpenTrack, VISSIM, Synchro, ArcGIS and QGIS.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)